

that a startup needed to make money, which was becoming difficult at LogicVision. Two years later, he started Ambit Design Systems. The company was bought by Cadence for \$280 million in under four years, putting him on the map and giving him the freedom to think about other ventures.

The successful exit also left Rajeev with a few life lessons. "I once walked away from a partner who was willing to fund us on a conditional basis, at a time when we did not have any money to pay salaries. I walked away from the deal without being able to explain my reasons to my team members and took a unilateral decision," he shares.

Cautioning against this attitude, Rajeev elucidates, "This approach never works. Over the years, I got better at explaining my decisions. A startup is not an individual sport; it is a team sport."

Immediately after Ambit, Rajeev jumped into Magma Design Automation as Founder, President, and CEO. By this time, Rajeev's mother had given up reprimanding him and concluded that her son could not hold on to a job!

Magma's software tools became known for their efficiency in facilitating low-power semiconductor designs without sacrificing performance, making it possible to build more power-efficient chips. The company's approach allowed designers to make adjustments and corrections early in the process, reducing the risk of costly revisions later.

Magma provided core infrastructure software to semiconductor pioneers, such as Qualcomm, NVIDIA, and Samsung, and enabled ASIC (application-specific integrated circuit) service providers, such as Open-Silicon (co-founded by Naveed Sherwani and Dr Satya Gupta), to offer timing and area predictability for reliable, predictable chip designs, which in turn helped them scale their businesses. Magma and Open-Silicon signed one of the largest EDA deals in India, and Chitra Hariharan and her team in India taped-out more than 100 chips using the Magma EDA tools. Many of the technologies developed by Magma became industry standards.

One of the pioneering examples of innovation at Magma was the use of parallel threads, which allowed designers to run multiple simulations simultaneously, reducing the overall time required for verification, even for complex chip designs. Parallel processing became a key enabler for handling the increasing complexity of modern semiconductor designs, especially in advanced nodes, such as 28nm, 14nm, and beyond.

Magma was listed on Nasdaq in 2001. During the time between Ambit's exit and Magma's sale to



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